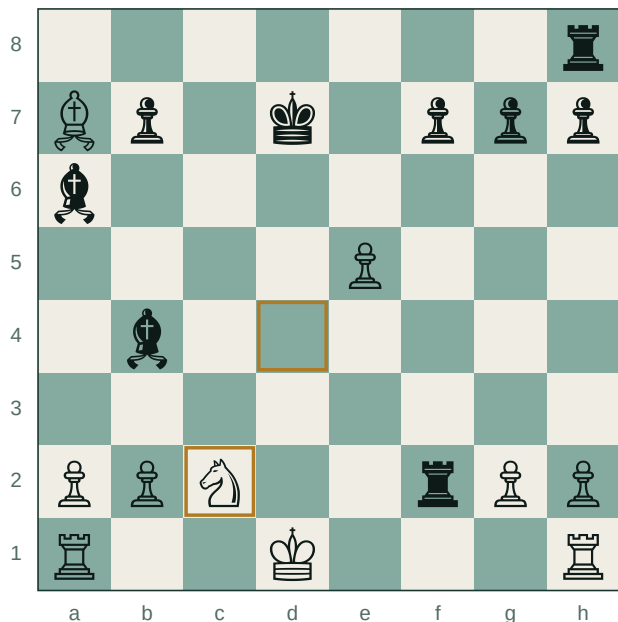


Pins and pressure: Black, move 19

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Nc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Rd2+ 20. Kc1 Rc8 21. Rd1 Rxc2+

19...Rd2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From d2 it attacks king on d1 and knight on c2. Recorded reply: **20.Kc1**.

20...Rc8 The rook moves from h8 to c8. Recorded reply: **21.Rd1**.

21...Rxc2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the knight on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on d1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on a7 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.